

for which you want to set permissions, and click 'OK'. (When you add a new user or group, this user or group will have Read & Execute, List Folder Contents and Read permissions by default). To delete a group or user select the user and click 'Remove'.

If the group or user is already listed, click the name of the group or user. You can now adjust their permissions. Select the permissions you want to set for the file or folder and click 'OK. To allow or deny a type of permission, select the 'Allow' or 'Deny' checkbox in the 'Permission for User or Group' dialog box.

10.2 Encrypting Files And Folders

One of the inbuilt features of XP is the encryption system, but one thing you should remember here is that it works only on NTFS. One of the most important advantages you gain when choosing the NTFS file system over older file systems such as FAT is that you have much greater control over who can perform what sorts of operations on various data within the filesystem. NTFS offers a secure environment and flexible control over what can be accessed by which users, to allow for many different users and groups of users to be networked together, with each able to access only the appropriate data.

Even after encrypting a file or folder, XP will not prompt you for a password to open the encrypted file, nor will it prompt you for a password while encrypting the file. The file is thus transparent to the user who encrypted it. However, if a different user tries to view or copy the encrypted file or folder, he'll see an 'Access Denied' message.

You also have the option to encrypt a folder including its sub-folders. If the owner of the encrypted file moves it to a FAT partition, the encryption will be lost. If you move an un-encrypted file into an encrypted folder, then the file that was moved also gets